



## **Subject Vision and Intent: French**

### **Our Vision**

At King's Cross Academy, we want every child to experience the excitement and satisfaction of communicating in another language. Through learning French throughout Key Stage 2, children develop the knowledge, confidence and curiosity to understand and express themselves in a language beyond those they already know.

Our ambition is for children to see language learning as an opportunity to connect with other people, places and cultures. We want them to become confident enough to have a go, resilient when communication is not immediately successful and curious about the similarities and differences between languages.

For many children at KCA, communicating in more than one language is already part of everyday life. Our French curriculum celebrates this linguistic diversity while giving every child the opportunity to study another language systematically and develop an understanding of how languages work.

Our French curriculum reflects our Academy vision, *Love Learning Together*. Learning another language requires children to listen carefully, communicate with others and learn through interaction. It also develops our KCA values: the courage to speak in an unfamiliar language, the respect to engage with another culture, the endurance to practise and improve, and the aspiration to communicate increasingly independently.

### **Our Intent**

Our French curriculum is ambitious, inclusive and carefully sequenced across Key Stage 2. Children learn French each week, progressively developing the vocabulary, phonics, grammatical knowledge and language structures they need to understand and communicate with increasing independence.

Our curriculum develops children's knowledge and confidence across listening, speaking, reading and writing. These elements are deliberately connected so that children encounter language in different forms and learn to apply what they know in increasingly varied contexts.

Listening and speaking are particularly important in establishing children's confidence as language learners. Children regularly hear accurate models of French, develop their

understanding of French sounds and pronunciation, and practise responding through words, phrases and increasingly complete sentences. Songs, rhymes, games, conversation and rehearsal provide frequent opportunities to hear and use the language.

As children's knowledge develops, they read increasingly complex words, phrases and short texts in French. They learn to use their developing knowledge of vocabulary, phonics and grammar to make sense of unfamiliar language rather than relying solely upon memorised phrases.

Children also learn to communicate through writing. They progress from words and simple phrases towards constructing and adapting increasingly complex sentences, drawing upon familiar vocabulary and grammatical structures to communicate their own meaning.

Vocabulary is deliberately selected, taught and revisited so that children build a secure body of language over time. Rather than encountering disconnected topics, children regularly retrieve and reuse previously learned vocabulary and structures in new contexts.

Children progressively develop an understanding of French phonics and grammar. They learn that languages have patterns and structures and begin to notice similarities and differences between French, English and the other languages they know. This knowledge helps children become increasingly confident in working out how language operates and in generating language for themselves.

We want children to move beyond simply repeating predetermined phrases. As their knowledge grows, they are encouraged to select and adapt vocabulary and structures to express their own ideas, ask and answer questions and communicate with increasing independence.

## **Every Child**

We have high expectations for every child. Children with SEND, children who are disadvantaged and children who are developing English as an additional language access the same ambitious French curriculum.

Teachers reduce barriers through clear modelling, visual support, repetition, gestures, structured speaking opportunities, carefully scaffolded tasks and frequent retrieval of previously learned language. Children have repeated opportunities to hear and rehearse language before being expected to use it independently.

We recognise that speaking in another language can make children feel vulnerable. Our classrooms therefore establish a culture in which having a go is valued and mistakes are understood as a normal and important part of learning a language.

The linguistic diversity of KCA is a significant strength. Children are encouraged to draw upon their experiences of different languages, noticing patterns, making comparisons and recognising that multilingualism is a valuable and ordinary part of our community.

We also recognise that opportunities to travel internationally and experience another language in its authentic context are not equally available to every child. Our curriculum therefore ensures that all children develop meaningful knowledge of French language and

culture and have opportunities to experience language as something that is used by real people in real places.

## **French Beyond the Classroom**

Our ambition is for children to understand that French is a living language for communication, not simply a subject studied for one lesson each week.

Throughout Key Stage 2, children encounter aspects of life and culture in France and the wider French-speaking world. This helps them understand that learning a language also provides opportunities to encounter different places, traditions and perspectives.

The culmination of children's French learning at KCA is our Year 6 residential visit to France.

The residential provides an authentic purpose for the knowledge children have developed throughout Key Stage 2. Children have opportunities to hear French being spoken around them, recognise familiar language and use their own French to communicate in real situations. Knowledge that has been developed progressively in the classroom becomes something children can apply beyond it.

The experience is also about developing children's confidence and independence. Ordering something, asking a question, understanding a sign or successfully communicating a simple message in another country can be a powerful demonstration of how far they have progressed as language learners.

We want every child to experience that moment of recognising: "I can actually use this."

By the end of Year 6, our aim is for children to understand and respond to increasingly familiar spoken and written French, communicate ideas using a growing vocabulary and range of grammatical structures, and draw upon their knowledge of phonics to read and pronounce unfamiliar language with increasing confidence.

Above all, we want children to leave KCA as curious, courageous and enthusiastic language learners who understand that learning another language enables them to communicate with people beyond their immediate world and who have the confidence and foundations to continue learning languages at secondary school and beyond.